Governor Newsom signs legislation to help Holocaust survivors recover art stolen by the Nazis

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Governor Gavin Newsom visited the Holocaust Museum LA on Monday with David Cassirer and the families of other Holocaust survivors to sign legislation that will help California residents recover art and other personal property stolen as a result of political persecution.

Today,Monday September 16 at the Holocaust Museum LA, Governor Gavin Newsom signed Assembly Bill (AB) 2867, legislation from Assemblymember Jesse Gabriel (Encino) that will help California residents recover art and other personal property stolen during the Holocaust or as a result of other acts of political persecution.

The bill was introduced following a recent decision by the Ninth Circuit Court of Appeals that has allowed a Spanish museum to retain possession of a famous Impressionist masterpiece stolen by the Nazis from the Cassirer family during the Holocaust. AB 2867 mandates that California law must apply in lawsuits involving the theft of art or other personal property looted during the Holocaust or due to other acts of political persecution.

"For survivors of the Holocaust and their families, the fight to take back ownership of art and other personal items stolen by the Nazis continues to traumatize those who have already gone through the unimaginable. It is both a moral and legal imperative that these valuable and sentimental pieces be returned to their rightful owners, and I am proud to strengthen California's laws to help secure justice for families."

"Governor Newsom's signature on this bill is a victory for morality and justice and will ensure that California continues to stand on the right side of history. AB 2867 will empower Holocaust survivors and other victims of persecution to reclaim stolen property and sends a clear message to those who refuse to return stolen art. I applaud Governor Newsom for his long standing leadership in standing up for Holocaust survivors and thank him for his partnership on this important new law."

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